

Jarrood Tran

Manager, AI & Factory Strategy

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SUMMARY

I turn ambiguous mandates into operating systems that move. Strategist and operator: set what, where, and when; scale and launch; hand off to a sustaining team. At Tesla Energy Manufacturing I own AI enablement for 10,000 employees and lead an FDE team for custom buildouts, with factory strategy and cost/regulatory mitigation beside that work. Prior Waymo Strategy & Ops, Apple iPhone India launch, Tesla 4680 special projects, Amazon fulfillment ops.

SELECTED RESULTS

- Tesla: \$260M annualized cost-down; \$156M incremental annual profit from a \$23M / 50+ initiative portfolio
- Tesla: \$550M projected tariff exposure mitigated; Megapack production scale 3.2×
- Tesla: 10k+ Energy Manufacturing employees on AI enablement; FDE custom buildouts (20+ tools, 1,000+ users, ~\$1.6M productivity)
- Apple: India revenue \$2B → \$10B; units 4.3M → 16.9M; exports 6 to 40+ countries

EXPERIENCE

Tesla — Manager, AI & Factory Strategy | Aug 2023 – Present

- Sequence a \$23M / 50+ initiative portfolio: \$260M annualized cost-down, \$156M incremental annual profit; Megapack scale 3.2× — then hand the playbooks to sustaining owners.
- Mitigate \$550M in projected tariff exposure by redesigning build plans and standing up FTZ, bonded-warehouse, and changeover infrastructure.
- Lead AI enablement across Tesla Energy Manufacturing (10,000 employees): as-is to to-be to ship to hand-off to a sustaining team.
- Stand up an FDE team for custom AI buildouts (20+ tools, 1,000+ active users, ~\$1.6M productivity).
- Own strategy on what we build, where we build it, and when we launch, plus regulatory and cost mitigation.

Waymo — Strategy & Operations Manager | Oct 2022 – May 2023

- Translated Engineering Operations priorities into one decision system across hardware, software, fleet, product, and legal so leadership could move without ad-hoc reporting.
- Installed annual planning, OKRs, resource plans, business reviews, and decision milestones that surfaced bottlenecks without ad-hoc reporting.

Apple — Strategic Operations Program Manager | Jun 2021 – Jun 2022

- Built the zero-to-one operating system for iPhone manufacturing in India under exacting quality, regulatory, and timing requirements.
- Shipped the ramp: revenue \$2B → \$10B, units 4.3M → 16.9M, exports expanded from 6 to 40+ countries — then handed the running operation to plant and supplier teams.

Tesla — Program Manager, Special Projects | Jun 2018 – Jun 2021

- Advanced Project Roadrunner (4680) from early battery-cell pilot to a production-ready platform.
- Installed stage gates, readiness reviews, and supplier coordination, then handed cross-functional launch ownership to engineering, production, and supply chain.
- Sustained Model 3 / Model Y rates through demand surges and supply disruptions.
- Designed and launched a \$3.5M/month Warehouse on Wheels logistics platform protecting battery and drivetrain flow.

Amazon — Operations Area Manager | Mar 2017 – Apr 2018

- Led a team of 100+ associates in a high-volume fulfillment center.

SKILLS

AI enablement and adoption | Factory and operating strategy | Special projects / launch readiness | Capacity and cost economics | Decision systems and executive cadence | Zero-to-one manufacturing launches

EDUCATION

University at Buffalo — B.S. Business Administration, Finance (Cum Laude)